



Darksiders 2

The unique protagonist returns with killer art style, savvy level design, and ferocious combat



HP Envy m4

HP announces thin and light Envy m4 with i3 and i5 processor, up to 8GB RAM and 1 TB HDD

find a fourth USB port along with HDMI out, composite out and the Ethernet port. When it comes to looks, this thing wins hands down, beating all other contenders by a mile.

The Boxee Box really does have a unique and eye-catching cube-ish design, which was conceived by the same people who designed the Xbx 360 – which perhaps explains the green! Yes, green, and not just your regular green, think fluorescent green. The base is that colour, and it contrasts well with the combination of glossy and matte black of the device.

Also, the base is rubberised – this will help the frequent recablers amongst us from accidentally tuggin on the wrong cable and causing floor and media player to meet. There's an illuminated Boxee logo on the front that glows – yup, you guessed it, it's green. It's green when you connect it to the network, and turns orange when not connected or in standby mode.

Now unique designs are not always the most ergonomic, and the Boxee ends up being a lot larger than most of the other

card slot. The O!Play Gallery looks exactly like the HD2, and offers a similar set of storage connectivity options. Surprisingly, the composite and component video outputs have been done away with. The addition is the iPod connectivity. The uninspiring design could have been tweaked, considering the extra price this device is selling for.

WALK THE PLANK! Features & performance Basic media players

Between the two contenders, Amkette Flash TV HD and O!Play Mini, it was pretty much a runaway win for the Flash TV HD – the startup was quicker, file playback started faster and HD and SD content playback slightly better than on the O!Play Mini.

It's neck-and-neck in terms of features, but the Flash TV HD takes the advantage in the build and ergonomics scores. It also has slightly better picture reproduction, and the same videos seem a tad crisper and livelier than on the O!Play Mini. This was most visible when playing back 1080p and 720p files.

Both offer very basic on-screen interfaces, and there really is nothing to differentiate the two. You see categories of media – video, photos and

The Seagate GoFlex TV handles original HD content brilliantly, but the upscaled content seems to miss out on the expected crispness. Surpris-



ASUS O!PLAY Air

music, and the customary settings menu. No options to tweak these either.

Media players with ethernet connectivity

This category consists of media players that offer web connectivity over the wired route, but without integrated wireless.

ASUS' O!Play (9.9 seconds) has the quickest startup time, with the Seagate GoFlex TV (13.9 seconds) a close second. WD Live Hub takes a while to start up and get ready – just under 40 seconds. All three devices are pretty comparable after that to the time taken to select and start playback of a chosen file off a USB drive. The WD Live Hub's final HD quality and up-scaled SD reproduction quality is superior to the other two though. We really liked the fact that you can tweak the brightness and contrast settings on the O!Play, to make videos looks livelier. Being able to tweak the output to suit your personal preference is a huge bonus as far as we're concerned. The overall picture quality of the Live Hub, with settings fixed, is the best and the O!Play comes a very close second.

ingly, Seagate doesn't have the 24p Cinema Mode option, something that seems pretty basic for a device that will playback HD videos. With the WD Live Hub, you can tweak the colour depth between 8-bit and 12-bit and also "set resolution to match frame rate", which is their version of the 24p mode.

WD's unique Mochi UI adds to the visual appeal, making the rivals' UI look more dated than they actually are! However, it goes without saying that Seagate's UI is better laid out than the one on the O!Play – which suffers from clutter because of huge icons. We were surprised how quick the file playback times were on the Seagate GoFlex HD when streaming content on the network, where the WD Live Hub was surprisingly sluggish.

The remote of the WD Live Hub is the most comfortable to use, and for the fingers to get used to. The remotes for Seagate's GoFlex TV and ASUS' O!Play aren't the easiest for the finger-memory (using without looking), but get the job done. The price of ₹13,500 for the Live Hub is fairly steep, which is why we believe the ASUS O!Play HDP-R1 (which costs just



WD TV Live (3rd Gen)

media players in this test, and can be a little bit of a pain to seat into your pre-built entertainment setup if you have a space crunch. Of course, because it's big, it also fits in all the necessary connectivity options easily – HDMI-out, two USB inputs and a memory

Upscaled content looks almost the same on both devices, with edge noise somewhat visible. The remotes for both devices are basic, but neither had an optimal key layout. It will be more of a case of getting used to either.